COUNTRY REPORTS: ANGOLA

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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Angola's cybersecurity strategy sets the creation of three institutions as its own strategic actions, and the executive built them by decree before the legislative reform the same document commits to. Presidential Decree 256/25 of 3 December 2025 approved the strategy, grounded in Law 7/17 and organised around six strategic objectives, and it makes creating the National Cybersecurity Council, the National Cybersecurity Centre and CERT.ao those strategic actions, while separately committing to a two-phase legislative reform whose first phase is passage of laws by the legislature. Presidential Decree 258/25 created the Conselho Nacional de Cibersegurança as a 21-member consultative body chaired by the President on the same day.

The statute followed ten months later: Lei n.º 9/26 of 28 September 2026 is in force, creating a national cybersecurity system of the council, the centre and a national network of incident-response teams, and requiring operators of critical infrastructure, essential services and electronic communications to register with the centre within 180 days and to notify significant incidents. The government's answer to the national carrier's cyberattack, given by the Secretary of State for Social Communication in the National Assembly on 31 July 2026, was that the existing programme to reinforce technological infrastructure will help the country protect itself.

Above cybersecurity sits a fuller stack of commitments. The White Paper on Information and Communication Technologies 2023-2027, approved on 5 December 2024, is the ICT strategy, setting the sector's policy and strategic measures towards five objectives for 2027. The 2025 GovTech assessment records a current digital transformation strategy, an established institution with a mandate for digital government and a data-governance function held by an autonomous institution and taken across government rather than sector by sector, alongside the digital transition agenda for public administration that the head of the Casa Civil set out at the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa's forum in March 2026. The named hole is artificial intelligence: UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, identified the absence of a National AI Strategy as a gap, alongside deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination.

The administrative base under all of it is improving from a low level: Angola scores 43.8 out of 100 for overall governance, 36th of 54 African states and below the continental average of 49.3 (2023), and Budgetary and Financial Management is its most deteriorated measure of the decade, down 13.9 points to 44.4 (2023).

Legislation and regulation

Angola's cybersecurity statute is law: it was published as Lei n.º 9/26 of 28 September 2026 and is in force, revoking the 2017 law and giving operators of critical infrastructure, essential services, electronic communications, data centres and cloud 180 days to register with the national cybersecurity centre. The National Assembly adopted the presidentially-initiated bill on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56, the governing party for and the opposition against

with no abstentions, directing it at the protection of networks, critical infrastructure and essential services through prevention, detection, incident response and restoration of affected systems. It had passed in generality on 23 January 2026 by 105 votes to one with 75 abstentions, been suspended in committee in July 2026 over non-conformities in its drafting, form and content, returned to chapter-by-chapter committee voting on 3 August and cleared the joint committee on 7 August 2026 by 23 votes to none with 10 abstentions. Its penalties are set in multiples of the national minimum wage rather than in kwanza, running from seven to 70 for individuals on the lightest administrative infringements up to 450 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious. It obliges telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, a duty the opposition and part of civil society object to on the ground that neither the qualifying content nor the circumstances in which a subscriber's personal data reaches the authorities is defined. The Council and Centre the bill provided for had already been created by Presidential Decree 258/25 and Presidential Decree 263/25 in December 2025, weeks before that first vote.

The statute before it punishes what people post: Lei n.º 6/26 was gazetted in Diário da República I Série n.º 146 and took effect on 4 August 2026, carrying one to three years' imprisonment for publishing false information, three to eight where the content incites hatred or damages a reputation, and up to ten where it compromises electoral processes or state security.

The electronic-signature regime will arrive as an executive instrument. Angola has no dedicated legal regime for electronic signatures, digital certification or public key infrastructure, and the National Assembly approved on 30 July 2026, unanimously with 166 votes in favour, the President's request for legislative authorisation to legislate it, which became Lei de Autorização Legislativa n.º 12/26 of 2 October 2026, giving the President 90 days to legislate the electronic signature and digital certification regime.

Three further texts are in the pipeline and none is law. A complete draft artificial-intelligence law went out for public consultation in September 2025; it singles out one class of system, "IA Crítica", for additional duties, leaves the competent authority to a future regulation, and repeals nothing. A digital government law entered public consultation on 6 May 2026, and a bill setting the legal regime for collecting and processing identity-card and criminal-record data was cleared by the Council of Ministers for the Assembly on 29 April 2026. What binds meanwhile is Law 23/11 on electronic communications, 2/20 on video-surveillance, 11/20 on cellular location and electronic surveillance, and the Criminal Code 38/20.

Data protection

The Agência de Protecção de Dados' own register listed 15 fines between 2022 and 2026, from US$75,000 to US$525,000, six of them dated 2026 and the largest levied on Banco de Poupança e Crédito in 2022 (October 2026). In deliberations reported in June 2026 the agency fined two technology firms more than Kz 600m between them — Crescer Tech US$505,000 for notification and authorisation failures and for transferring client data to cloud servers outside Angola, and Fast Digital Center US$112,000 for inadequate security measures. Those follow sanctions divulged in September 2025 against TAAG at US$100,000 and the Banco de Desenvolvimento de Angola at US$75,000; a US$115,000 penalty against a hotel was published in August 2026.

The instrument behind that is Law 22/11, the omnibus statute setting processing principles, regulating sensitive data including genetic data, and establishing the authority with notification and authorisation powers. It gives the regulator real teeth: it applies fines itself, its deliberations become executive titles, and refusing the collaboration it requires is a crime. Operators must also notify it of any breach compromising personal data, and Circular 2/2024 of October 2024 sets out what an incident report must contain.

The regulator's independence is thinner than its powers. Every seat on its board is a presidential appointment, any member may be exonerated at any time by decree with no stated grounds or procedure, and the whole board may be dissolved on a change of orientation about its management — including the three members the National Assembly elects and the judge elected by the Conselho Superior da Magistratura Judicial. Superintendence was delegated to the telecommunications minister by the 2019 decree that appointed its board.

State processing largely sits outside the regime. Authorisation is dispensed with wherever processing derives from a legal instrument, and processing under the rules on state secrecy, state security and segredo de justiça falls outside the law altogether. Lei n.º 11/20 gives the authority only knowledge and monitoring of the criminal police database, permits cross-matching against other databases and against private, commercial and residential video-surveillance, and obliges those cameras' owners to give the police access. Amnesty International's Security Lab confirmed Predator spyware active on an Angolan journalist's phone on 4 May 2024, and Portugal's Expresso reported in February 2026 that an April 2021 contract record names the state intelligence service SINSE as its end-user. Identity data is outside the surveillance regime as well as the protection one: the South African research organisation Intelwatch's field report of 8 August 2026 found no rule stating when the intelligence service may obtain identity, biometric or mobility data and no independent body to review such requests, and the migration service confirmed at the Santa Clara border post that SINSE may request access under established protocols. The same report puts the national biometric border-control system at US$112m, awarded in February 2025 to Dolinveste Lda with Poland's Technology for Business, on its account by direct award rather than open tender, and a further EUR 130m passport and biometric identity contract with Hungary's ANY Security Printing, taking the total past US$250m without significant tender, parliamentary scrutiny or human-rights impact assessment; it records no biometric system operating at the border posts with the Democratic Republic of the Congo, crossings there regulated by a manually checked seven-day paper pass, and the one functional post, Santa Clara, reading passports against the migration database with fingerprint and height capture discontinued on maintenance grounds. The figures and the characterisation of the awards are Intelwatch's; no procurement record is on file.

Regional collaboration

The part of Angola's digital estate that has actually crossed a border is its satellite. Mozambique's Boane Earth Station was receiving the ANGOSAT-2 signal in operational tests when the two countries signed space and ICT cooperation memoranda in June 2026; an ICT memorandum with Namibia, signed at ANGOTIC 2026 in Luanda, covers joint cybersecurity work and the exchange of technical expertise, and was signed alongside a Telecom Namibia pilot commercial agreement for ANGOSAT-2 services that followed a proof of concept; and the space agency GGPEN signed a space-science cooperation agreement with Nigeria's NASRDA at the same event.

On treaties the record is one approved and one pending. The National Assembly approved the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection by Resolution 33/19 of 9 July 2019, and no deposit of an instrument of ratification is on record. Angola has signed the UN Convention against Cybercrime, with ratification outstanding as at 3 March 2026.

Its main multilateral digital programme is not wholly its own to steer. Angola takes part in the regional IDEA digitalisation programme, with the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa as its national focal point, and its Digital Acceleration Project is one national slice of a five-state programme with the DRC, Zambia, Malawi and Eswatini whose third steering committee met in Lusaka on 30 July 2026. Angola's project had disbursed US$112.21 million of its US$300 million loan by June 2026. The programme's inaugural forum in Lusaka on 29 July 2026 recommended harmonisation of member states' digital policies.

Luanda is also hosting the traffic. SADC's third preparatory meeting for the ITU World Radiocommunication Conference 2027 opened there on 3 August 2026, five days of member-state experts on spectrum management, regional integration, connectivity and network resilience. The data-protection authority signed a memorandum with Brazil's Autoridade Nacional de Proteção de Dados at the 47th Global Privacy Assembly in Seoul, committing to mutual assistance and technical, regulatory and supervisory cooperation. Against all of that, Regional Integration remains among Angola's ten worst-scoring governance measures at 21.2 out of 100 (2023), 48th of 54 African states despite membership of both ECCAS and SADC.

In the Lusophone frame, Angola signed the CPLP Charter of Rights and Principles in Digital Environments at São Tomé on 19 July 2024 with all nine member states — expressly declaratory and non-binding, committing signatories to meaningful connectivity on non-discriminatory and affordable terms, personal data protection, cybersecurity cooperation, digital literacy and non-fragmentation of the digital environment, and condemning blanket internet shutdowns, and its regulators joined a Maputo workshop in December 2025 where UNESCO launched the Portuguese edition of its Data Governance Toolkit and more than 40 data-protection authorities and ICT regulators from Angola, Guinea-Bissau, São Tomé and Príncipe and Mozambique mapped national data arrangements against the African Union Data Policy Framework and the Smart Africa Data Governance Blueprint. No domestic measure is recorded as taken under any of them. Angola is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that satellite observation data be open to all save justified exceptions, published on 10 September 2026.

Standards

Angola has a national standards body and it works by catalogue rather than by mandate. The quality-infrastructure institute formed by the 2021 merger of the standardisation and accreditation bodies is an ISO correspondent member, a category carrying no vote on technical work, and published a 2026 national standards catalogue incorporating 140 new standards, some from SADC regional harmonisation, stating that Angolan standards are voluntary and become mandatory only where legislation in the public interest makes them so. The one standard the state has legislated for its own data is geographic: Lei n.º 8/25 fixes unique sequential alphanumeric codes for the country, its 21 provinces, 326 municipalities and 378 communes, on criteria the law says are drawn from ISO standards expressly to ease data exchange between national and international systems, leaving codes vacated by an abolished unit permanently unassigned.

The most exactingly specified technical standard Angola publishes governs closed-circuit cameras. The video-surveillance regulation of December 2021 fixes IP66 and IK-10 housings, H.264/H.265 encoding, native TCP/IP with IPv6, Full HD 1080p at 60 frames per second, 36x optical zoom and programmable privacy masks, with all transmission encrypted and keys rotated every six months, and specifies the mandatory warning sign down to its pictogram, its wording and a mounting height no lower than 1.50 m.

Government interoperability is older and thinner. Presidential Decree 46/18 approved PNAGIA, the national plan for a global interoperability architecture across central and local state administration, and the 2025 GovTech assessment records that framework and a Government Service Bus in place but only partially used across public bodies. The institute procuring the replacement has now put a number on how partial: its 2026 terms of reference disclose a seven-month study across 25 public institutions finding only 27% of systems interconnected, with integration predominantly ad hoc. On trust services the floor is missing rather than partial: no public key infrastructure has been established, and the law behind the identity card's chip provides for no authentication mechanism.

Where published standards do bind, they bind through the tax and payments rails. Electronic invoices must be issued from software certified by the tax authority and transmitted in real time, on SAF-T as the underlying data standard, and the central bank has completed the migration of domestic payments to the ISO 20022 international messaging standard.

Regulatory practice is being built with outside help, and the state's own document handling still slips. Portugal's telecommunications regulator ANACOM held cooperation meetings in Luanda in March 2026 with INACOM and the EU Delegation, presenting an institutional-strengthening training initiative in ICT policy and regulation. MINTTICS republished its 2025 procurement plan on 5 March 2025, keeping the same 29 projects but correcting the ministry total from Kz 616.7 biliões — larger than Angola's entire 2025 state budget — to Kz 225.6 mil milhões.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Angola scores far better on digital freedom than on the freedom of its press: Digital Freedom is one of its ten best-scoring governance measures at 70.9 out of 100 (2023), 19th of 54 African states, while Media Freedom fell 2.7 points over 2014-2023 to 45.1 out of 100, 38th of 54, and Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 1.3 points to 49.2, 35th of 54 — both moving against the country's overall governance improvement.

The newest instrument bears on the first of those. The law governing what Angolans may publish online took effect on 4 August 2026; UNITA voted against it on the ground that the text opens the way to criminalising journalists and ordinary users, while the MPLA framed it as combating structured disinformation. The same argument runs through the cybersecurity bill, where opponents warn it could become an instrument of abusive surveillance and digital repression without strong judicial guarantees, against the responsible minister calling it strategically important.

Consultation on digital law is real and recent — the artificial-intelligence bill was published in full on the telecommunications ministry's consultation portal, and the digital government bill went out for consultation on 6 May 2026 — and the Assembly does settle digital questions in the open, rejecting a UNITA bill to open the electoral personal-data registers in plenary on 25 June 2026 on the argument that it would expose sensitive data without consent. The standing machinery is weaker than the set-piece. Angola has an online public participation platform, with a separate portal handling petitions, and a citizen feedback mechanism for public services that lacks every one of the supporting capabilities the 2025 assessment tests for.

Access to the record is the constraint. A right to information law is graded as in force rather than adopted and dormant (2025), but disclosure of public records is among Angola's worst-scoring governance measures, and the documentation behind most assessed government systems and oversight functions — the interoperability framework, the national service portal, the digital government mandate, the transformation strategy and the data-protection authority's reporting — is held internally and not published.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Angola's 2025 budget law put the national broadband network and the government cloud on the state's own books in large sums: it appropriates Kz 107.8 billion to the national broadband network and Kz 70.5 billion to the analytics platform, main and backup data centres and national cloud platform (FY2025), against Kz 1.4 billion and Kz 2.0 billion for the same two lines a year earlier (FY2024).

The digital lines of the 2025 budget law come to Kz 384.4 billion appropriated, up from Kz 142.1 billion in 2024, and those two lines account for most of the rise (FY2025).

The 2025 law prints its financing split only for the budget as a whole, 20.47% of it external (FY2025). The 2025 budget law does not print the source of financing against its digital lines (FY2025). No outturn against the digital appropriations had been published as at September 2026.

The externally financed build has a closing date. The World Bank's US$300 million digital acceleration loan is on IBRD terms, a reference rate plus variable spread with a 0.25% front-end fee, and it closes in March 2030; the US$210.91 million of digital-state purchases the President authorised between February and August 2026, from public digital infrastructure and digital identity to interoperability, AI and cybersecurity, run through that project.

What the state has in law to carry its own share is a levy on the operators. The communications development fund takes 1% of public telecommunications operators' gross revenue under a 2010 presidential decree, and the national cybersecurity centre's 2025 statute sends 30% of the revenue it collects, fines included, to a cybersecurity fund that no decree had constituted as at September 2026. The public administration's digital transition agenda, approved by Presidential Decree 178/24 in July 2024, makes financing and sustainability one of its seven axes, to identify funding sources and bring in the private sector.

MoUs and other agreements

Angola's national government cloud originates in a memorandum rather than a contract: the Angola–United Arab Emirates agreement of December 2021, whose five agreed heads as the telecoms ministry set them out are a three-year digitalisation master plan for Angola, public-private partnerships, build-operate-transfer and other financing channels, digital skills and workforce development, and further projects of mutual interest. It was operationalised between MINTTICS and the Abu Dhabi big-data firm Presight, which signed its own memorandum with the government the same month to develop a transformation programme for "Digital Angola".

The ANGOTIC conference in June 2026 produced a further cluster of agreements: GGPEN and Africell on expanding ANGOSAT-2 services, Eutelsat and the Angolan provider Mercury Telecom on multi-year LEO capacity, Telecom Namibia and GGPEN on a pilot for ANGOSAT-2 capacity, alongside a ministerial ICT cooperation memorandum between the two countries, and Unitel and Angola Telecom on infrastructure sharing in underserved border regions.

State-to-state and regulator-to-regulator instruments run alongside. The data protection authority and Brazil's ANPD signed on technical assistance, regulation and supervision at the Global Privacy Assembly in Seoul; the Banco Nacional de Angola and the DRC's central bank signed on payment-system interoperability and cheaper cross-border payments in July 2026; a digital-governance pact was signed with Cape Verde in March 2026; and Angola and Kenya agreed at the Luanda summit on financing Africa's infrastructure to fast-track an ICT cooperation memorandum. Three memoranda signed at the modernisation institute's forum in March 2026 cover broadband connectivity, digital inclusion and the national digital-identity system.

The largest sum any private party has attached to Angola's digital estate also rests on a framework: the Cybastion and Angola Telecom investment announced in June 2025 sits on a memorandum of understanding signed at Mobile World Congress in Barcelona in March 2025.

New investments

The World Bank's US$300 million loan for the Angola Digital Acceleration Project had disbursed US$112.21 million, 37.40 per cent of the total, by the Bank's fourth supervision report (June 2026), against a closing date of March 2030. That is a recovery from a standing start: the loan was approved in June 2024 and signed that October, yet was still not effective in March 2025, with nothing disbursed beyond US$1 million drawn from a preparation advance and both its outcome and implementation ratings cut to Moderately Unsatisfactory, before the Bank restored them to Moderately Satisfactory in June 2026. The money is appropriated US$100m to connectivity and inclusion,

US$122.25m to inclusive and safe digital public infrastructure, US$54m to productive digital usage and US$23m to project management (June 2026). The regional programme's report for January to June 2026 records the three memoranda that are withdrawal conditions under the loan signed, with 17 contracts signed and 29 tenders under way.

China Eximbank lent RMB 1,736,207,810.54 on concessional terms for the national broadband network, under a framework agreement of January 2023 and a specific loan agreement that October. France arranged the largest European commitment, €225,257,201 through Société Générale for the Earth-observation satellite programme, signed in January 2025. Alongside these sit US$250 million for Projecto Njila across eight provinces from 2023, US$60 million for statistical capacity to 2027, an announced Cybastion and Angola Telecom investment in cybersecurity and a Luanda–Lobito cable (June 2025), and from an earlier cycle a US$66 million JBIC buyer's credit for the South Atlantic Cable System.

Domestic appropriation for connectivity is shrinking: the named connectivity programme was cut 30.5% to Kz 159.2 billion in the 2026 state budget after rising from Kz 7.4 billion in 2024, with the 4G expansion line down 42% to Kz 62.7 billion and the 3G coverage rubric deleted altogether. The World Bank's tertiary education project, a US$150m loan and a US$50m education-partnership grant, carries US$10m to digitalise higher-education services, US$15m for a national research and education network and US$15m for the sector's management information system; its second results-based funding round, US$20,470,284 across seven higher-education institutions, was announced on 4 September 2026. Private networks drew their own lender: the US Export-Import Bank announced a US$99.6m loan to Africell for network technology in Angola in September 2026.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Angola's mobile market is concentrated to the point where one operator's failure is close to a national one: Unitel carried about 20.8 million customers in July 2026, and when its network went down at the end of that month Africell was the only operator running fully.

The regulator's own series, reported to the ITU in November 2025, is the better-evidenced measure of reach: 55.50% of individuals used the internet in 2024, against 48.80% in 2023 and 42.10% in 2022, on 12,785,472 broadband subscriptions at 36.40% penetration and 26,407,932 mobile subscriptions at 75.19%, with national population coverage of 89.60% on 2G, 85.66% on 3G, 77.41% on 4G and 16.40% on 5G — 5G reaching only Luanda, Benguela and Huambo of the then eighteen provinces, and Luanda alone at 100% on 2G, 3G and 4G. The ministry's own figures run higher and on a different basis: it put the country above 28 million mobile subscriptions and above 17 million broadband users in March 2026, and Angola's mobile communications score rose 27.6 points over 2014–2023 to 69.1 out of 100, one of its ten most improved governance measures of the decade — while Angolans' own rating of the country's infrastructure, at 27.0 out of 100 in 2023, slipped 0.5 points over the same ten years.

The terrestrial fibre network connects every provincial and communal capital (May 2023), but the government conceded in June 2026 that weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the chief risk to completing the electoral register update, and the justice ministry attributed four months of outages at identification and civil registry posts across most of the country to telecommunications breakdowns (May 2026). An entry-level mobile broadband basket cost about 1.53% of gross national income per capita in 2024, inside the UN Broadband Commission's 2% target when measured against average national income.

The state's own backbone build has reached its first delivery: the first link of the national fibre broadband network, a route from Luanda through Bengo and Cuanza Sul, went into service at Lobito on 16 September 2026, with Huambo, Namibe and Cabinda named for the next phase, the ministry putting the completed section at about 400 Gb.

International capacity keeps arriving. Unitel put US$43 million into Angola's branch of the 2Africa cable and its landing station at Cacuaco, securing 23.6 Tbps of the cable's capacity for the country (December 2025), and a June 2026 agreement with Telecom Namibia and SATCAB gives Angola Telecom an initial 1.0 Tbps of Equiano capacity. Yet used international bandwidth stood at 5.50 kbit/s per capita in November 2025, unchanged from the June 2024 baseline and against a project target of 10, and what would keep traffic local is thin: two active internet exchange points with 29 members between them in June 2026, present in one of the fourteen population centres above 300,000. The broadband programme has no free-standing plan of its own — it sits inside the ICT White Paper 2023-2027, brought into force by Presidential Decree 272/24 in December 2024, which expressly repealed the 2019-2022 White Paper and frames the national broadband strategy, spectrum management and the national cybersecurity strategy.

ANGOSAT-2 capacity was opened to commercial internet providers in December 2025, and 37 firms had begun joining the commercial arm of the Conecta Angola satellite project by April 2026. The Digital Acceleration Project's outcome indicators for broadband users, users of digital services and adopting firms all still read zero on 30 April 2026, against a contracted target of 13.5 million people brought to broadband by the project itself by March 2030. The largest operator reported more than 21.2 million subscribers and 12,302 base stations for the first half of 2026.

Data Storage

Angolans' passports and education certificates, until then held by foreign entities or platforms, are to be stored on national infrastructure instead in the state's own data centre, opened in April 2026.

The Data Center e Cloud do Governo at Camama in Luanda was inaugurated by President João Lourenço on 28 April 2026, and occupies 6,225 m² built to Tier III of the Uptime Institute classification, with 208 racks and 1,040 kW of power capacity. It was an US$89 million project led by the state IT agency INFOSI with Presight and G42, hosting more than 80 government services on a single sovereign cloud as at April 2026, replicated by a secondary site and fibre-linked to the ministries of finance, telecommunications, interior, education and health, with public services facing a progressive and mandatory migration onto the national cloud it carries. The sovereignty this is presented as securing originates in a December 2021 memorandum between Angola and the United Arab Emirates, operationalised between the ministry and the Emirati firm Presight. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment nonetheless records no whole-of-government cloud service and no government cloud policy for Angola.

Commercial capacity is thin and sits in Luanda. Raxio's AG1 at Cacuaco, opened in October 2025 as a US$30 million investment, offers up to 3 MW and more than 800 racks on a 19,000 m² site near the undersea cable landings and is the country's only Tier III commercial facility; Paratus runs two data centres in the city and in 2023 began building a third, and Africell built an enterprise data centre at its Luanda headquarters in 2021. There is no in-country hyperscale cloud region: the nearest AWS, Azure and Google Cloud regions are elsewhere in Africa (2024).

No broad data localisation requirement applies, though banking and oil and gas data is mostly hosted locally in practice, and personal-data transfers abroad are subject to an adequate-protection test and notification of the data protection authority (2025). Financial institutions must notify the central bank and obtain its approval before contracting cloud or data-processing services, and disclose the hosting country, and private credit bureaux must keep their primary processing and replica sites in Angola, at least 30 km apart, and may use cloud storage only with the data protection authority's prior authorisation (Presidential Decree 275/20, 2020); the data protection

authority has fined a technology firm for moving client data to cloud servers outside Angola without authorisation (June 2026). The National Press inaugurated its own data centre in Luanda on 11 September 2026, for producing and certifying high-security state documents, with more than 170 TB of storage; no cost is published.

Energy

Afrobarometer reported in 2023 that 14% of rural Angolans lived in areas the national grid serves, against 92% of urban residents — a gap of some 78 percentage points, and the constraint that decides where a digital economy can actually run.

Nationally, 51.1% of the population had access to electricity in 2023. Angola's Access to Energy score reached 48.0 out of 100 in 2023, 20th of 54 African states, after rising 10.2 points over the decade to 2023 — improvement from a low floor rather than arrival. Generation is heavily hydro: hydropower supplied 88.5% of electricity output in 2020.

Off-grid provision is covered by a comprehensive policy framework spanning geospatial planning, subsidies, private-sector participation, mini-grids and standalone solar (2024). On the ground it is connectivity projects that carry their own power: Ilumina Angola reaches remote sites with shared towers, solar power and satellite backhaul, and Cubango's move to electronic provincial administration is planned around weak electricity as well as weak internet in its municipalities (December 2025).

Technical Capacity

Angola's identity and civil registration systems depend on suppliers the state does not control: the World Bank's 2024 diagnostic found the civil registration software locked to its vendor, which has never handed the government its source code, the Chinese state firm CEIEC providing technical coordination of the PGIBI identity platform, and services constrained by limited human and logistical resources, and recommended standard operating procedures backed by staff training.

The same weakness shows in delivery. All but one of the technical activities of the Digital Acceleration Project were significantly delayed at April 2025, the exception being interoperability work, and the delay extended to the upstream technical studies meant to shape the investments downstream of them. The Bank raised both project ratings in June 2026 on improved collaboration between the participating institutions, while institutional capacity and stakeholder risk both stayed above their levels at approval.

UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, named deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination alongside the absence of a national AI strategy. Inside government, the human resource management system for the public service is still being implemented rather than in use, and runs on commercial off-the-shelf software (2025), and Angola sat below the African average on the UN's e-government index in 2024.

Cybersecurity

Angola's cybersecurity law was published as Lei n.º 9/26 of 28 September 2026 and is in force, revoking the 2017 law, creating a national cybersecurity system with CERT.ao as the operational arm of its centre and requiring operators to notify significant incidents. The National Assembly had adopted it on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56. The statute it revoked was Law 7/17 on the protection of networks and computer systems, which required the organisations it covered to adopt security measures and notify the data-protection authority of incidents compromising data security.

The regulator predates the new statute: Presidential Decree 263/25, published on 10 December 2025, created the Centro Nacional de Cibersegurança as a public institute under the superintendence of the telecommunications minister, who may suspend or revoke its management's unlawful acts; its statute gives it regulation, rule-making,

supervision, inspection and sanctioning powers, and the ability to issue binding circulars and instrutivos on the entities it supervises, and Article 25 splits the revenue it collects, fines included, 40% to the Treasury, 30% to the Centro and 30% to a cybersecurity fund.

CERT.ao exists as a department inside the Centro rather than as a separate agency, and the World Bank recorded no national CIRT established as at 30 April 2026. The Centro is not yet operating: on 12 October 2026 the telecommunications ministry said a national commission would be formed to create, within 180 days, the conditions to implement it. The one binding sectoral rule predates all of it and belongs to the central bank: Aviso n.º 8/20 of 2 April 2020 sets the rules on cyber-security policy and on the terms and conditions of contracting data-processing, data-storage and cloud-computing services for the institutions the bank supervises.

The bill's own design was contested before the vote. In January 2026 the national bar association told the National Assembly that the cybersecurity bill and the bill against false information should be read as a single package and both required integral reformulation, arguing that the proposed Centro Nacional de Cibersegurança would combine regulation, rule-making, supervision, inspection and sanction in one body in breach of the separation of powers, that article 15(1)(f)'s allowance of access to private communications on a "judicial or administrative" decision was constitutionally unacceptable and should require prior judicial authorisation, and that undefined terms — "cyber threat", "acts against state security" — invited arbitrary enforcement, while its registration and notification duties would deter publication of vulnerability research.

The test arrived on 28 July 2026, when Unitel lost mobile voice, data and internet nationwide from 02:20 to a cyberattack, its fixed fibre and fixed-wireless services staying up. Services were reported restored on 5 August 2026, nine days later, with card payment terminals among the channels lost, and the operator declared its core mobile services fully restored nationwide on 21 August 2026, with only the custom ringback-tone feature still offline and affected users receiving automatic invoice credits or additional service days. Unitel had disclosed no attribution or attack vector as at 31 July 2026, saying only that sensitive customer data had not been compromised; on the scope of loss the operator states that a continuing forensic investigation with independent external experts has found no evidence of unauthorised access to or sharing of customer or partner personal data, which is its own account and not a regulator's finding. The attack came in the week Unitel's shares were admitted to trading on the BODIVA exchange.

Angola sat in the evolving tier of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index in 2024 — a position the National Cybersecurity Strategy cites as its own justification — and the 2026 state budget proposal cut the appropriation for improving that position. The president authorised US$4.6m on 31 August 2026 to strengthen state cybersecurity.

DPI

Data Exchange

Angola contracted the hardware for its interoperability layer in June 2026, eight years after approving the plan for it: the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa signed the implementation contract with TIS Tech Angola for the US$150m Projecto de Infra-estruturas Digitais Públicas on 17 June, a twelve-month build specified as the secure-zone host for the interoperability platform, PKI-based electronic signatures and digital identity. Presidential Decree 46/18 had approved PNAGIA in 2018. Implementation and the management of training were both put out to tender in February 2026 under the World Bank-financed digital acceleration project, the platform set on a controlled data-reuse "once-only" principle against a diagnostic finding 27% of systems interconnected, with a separate consultancy for training the institutions that will use it. The framework study and platform roadmap were completed in the first half of 2026, and the platform itself, an enterprise service bus on X-Road, is under tender at about US$13.0m.

What runs today is narrower: Angola has a government interoperability framework and a Government Service Bus, the framework only partially used across public bodies (2025), with the electronic procurement system connected to other systems by direct interfaces and the bus. SEPE, the public services portal, is meant to serve as the interoperability platform, though most government websites and online services still run separately from it, and the identity platform is interoperable with several public platforms, among them the financial management system SIGFE, the social-security institute and the Investor Portal (2024).

The foundational registers are the gap. Civil registration has no central database, its two systems keeping separate records and some offices still on paper, and interoperability between civil registration and identification is set as a priority reform. The President created an interministerial commission in June 2026 tasked with stabilising interoperability between the civil-identification database and the adult-citizen database. Kwenda, the main social protection programme, issues its own beneficiary identifier rather than using the national identity system, making cross-referencing against other government databases difficult (2024).

What does cross is largely statutory and periodic. The electoral register is populated from the national civil identification database by an annual computerised file; Law 13/19 requires civil registration to pass vital-event data on foreign citizens to the Immigration Authority; the identity card is generated from the birth-registration record through interoperability between the two systems. Financial messaging has moved faster: the central bank completed migration of domestic payments to ISO 20022 on 10 July 2026, covering EMIS, the BODIVA exchange and the SPTR settlement system. So has surveillance: a SITA advance passenger data system has been deployed at Luanda's airport, feeding a new passenger-information monitoring centre (December 2025), and the President approved about €552,000 for a 36-month software licence under the FATCA agreement, through which account data on US taxpayers held at Angolan financial institutions goes to the US Internal Revenue Service (June 2026).

Two 2025–26 instruments make exchange a condition of a decision rather than an aspiration. A single window launched in September 2025 has a citizen lodge a land-concession file once at the municipal administration, the state then routing it through the tax authority, the geographic and cadastral institute and the property-registry conservatories. And in compulsory social protection, Presidential Decree 11/26 requires the managing entity's information exchange with other public and private institutions to observe national and international standards of interoperability, security and personal-data protection — a duty stated in statute for a system whose own registers are among those recorded as not connected. The tax and customs administration is integrating the commerce ministry's and other licensing bodies' platforms with its own, under service-level agreements that set response times (September 2026). The transport minister said on 28 September 2026 that a logistics single window is being completed with the tax administration and two other ministries; no launch date is stated.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Just over half of Angolans aged five and over — 52.4% — held the Bilhete de Identidade at the 2024 census reference date, and the state is now legislating to make that card the only document that counts: a Council of Ministers bill of 29 April 2026 would make it the sole valid identification document, mandatory for banking, telecoms, school enrolment, property registration and contracts.

Holding is unevenly spread. 63% of urban residents held the card against 30.9% of rural residents (September 2024), and it rises steeply with age — 30% of those aged 5-14, 55% of those aged 15-24 and 66% of those aged 25 and over (2024).

Decreto Presidencial 169/25 opened a supplementary credit of USD 218,500,000 inside the enacted 2025 budget on 19 September 2025 for the universalisation plan launched by decree in November 2024. Production has been pushed out from the single Kilamba centre: all 21 provinces printed the card locally as at July 2026, and a home

service launched on 28 July 2026 brings biometric capture to the house across Luanda province, at 250,000 kwanzas for processing and 10,000 for delivery alone. More than 120,000 issued cards sat uncollected in July 2026. 17,166,000 identity cards had been issued at home and in the diaspora by 24 September 2026, more than 1,100,000 of them in the universalisation campaign, against a target of a card for every adult in the civil registry by December 2026, on the registries director's count.

The credential is biometric, with ten fingerprints, photograph, signature and height captured at enrolment, but the civil-identification law provides for no authentication mechanism, digital certificate or public key infrastructure for its chip, all still at the planning stage. The one quantified digital-identity target, 10 million people with digitally verifiable identification by March 2030, had a baseline of zero and stood at zero in April 2025. Procurement of the missing layer opened in August 2026: Despacho Presidencial 300/26 of 13 August authorised USD 28,000,000 and opened public tender for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to carry up to 30 million digital identities and to support identification, authentication and legally valid electronic signature. No supplier or delivery date is stated.

Underneath the card, the registration pipeline is thinner still. Only 39.2% of children aged 0-4 had their birth registered in 2024, up from 24.8% in 2014 — the newest cohort is the least registered. The 2023-24 demographic and health survey puts the same measure at 38% of children under five registered with the civil registry and 36% holding a birth certificate, independently corroborating the census and separating what the census counts as one: registration and the document that proves it are two percentage points apart. Most civil registration and identification records are still held in unindexed paper files. Nascer com Registo, run by three ministries with EU and UNICEF support, places registry posts inside maternity wards so newborns leave registered and with a first card; at the Zaire provincial hospital it has registered newborns since October 2025, and it was formally launched at Mbanza Kongo in March 2026.

Tech By Tech released its AngolaID wallet in test mode, reported 9 October 2026: a credential created by video liveness check and facial recognition, verifiable by QR code, with an API and SDK for banks, schools and clinics; the company says it neither issues nor replaces the state identity card.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The kwanza was introduced as a settlement currency in the SADC real-time gross settlement system on 27 July 2026, only the second in the system's history, which had cleared exclusively in rand since 2013. Angolan customers reach it indirectly, through five participating commercial banks, the central bank naming removal of the correspondent-banking layer as the gain.

Domestically the growth is on the instant rail. KWiK carried about 35 million transfers worth 590 billion kwanzas during 2025, more than doubling year on year, and Angola counted more than 12.3 million registered payment accounts and roughly 24.8 million active payment keys in February 2026. By number of transfers the rail is led by non-banks: Paypay handled 52.2% of KWiK transfers in February 2026, against 21.9% for Banco BAI and 12.6% for Unitel Money, leaving sixteen banks to share the rest, and 66.4% of that month's transfers were for less than 10,000 kwanzas. By value banks lead: of the Kz 557.4bn moved over KWiK in the first half of 2026 banks originated about 62% and digital wallets about 38%, nearly all of the wallets' share going to bank accounts, with wallet-to-wallet transfers at 0.6% of the total. EMIS operates all of it — the Multicaixa ATM and POS network, five clearing systems and KWiK — KWiK built with the central bank and joined by 22 banking and non-bank financial institutions (January 2026).

About half of Angolans are unbanked and mobile money penetration is around 6%, although some 70% own a mobile phone (2025). The identity card is a prerequisite for opening a bank account or obtaining a loan, which ties financial access to the register's incomplete coverage. The cash-transfer programme Kwenda has paid mostly in cash: 77% of its payments in its first three years were made in cash, 23% by electronic card and 0.4% by mobile money, its operator told parliament in August 2023, and it began paying into beneficiaries' own bank accounts in Cabinda in January 2025, starting with 91 households. Afrimoney, Africell's mobile money service, launched in April 2023 to bridge the formal and informal economies, and counted 3 million wallet users among Africell's 8 million subscribers in September 2026.

The central bank oversees the payment system, having strengthened its oversight policy and restructured its own payments unit alongside a new Payments System Law, with payment-service provision governed by Aviso 2/22 under the 2020 Payment System Law, Lei 40/20 — a perimeter it has rebuilt twice since. Aviso 4/25 of 22 August 2025 set the rules for opening, operating and closing electronic-money accounts, defining four account types graded by how the holder proves identity and opening them to under-18s on a parental responsibility term, to non-resident foreigners with legal stay and to micro and small companies, and Aviso 1/26 of 28 January 2026 required every non-bank acquirer of payment terminals or ATMs to be a central-bank-authorised payment service provider, certified under the Multicaixa arrangement and holding a float account at a bank, and confining sub-acquirers to contracted agent activities on behalf of a financial institution. The value limits are set separately and the state exempts itself from them: Instrutivo n.º 02/2025 caps Multicaixa payments at Kz 30m a day, credit transfers at Kz 50m and direct debits at Kz 30m per operation, makes real-time gross settlement compulsory above Kz 50m, and then gives the finance ministry, the social-security institute and the central bank a Kz 99,999,999.99 per-operation Multicaixa ceiling and outright exemption from the credit-transfer limit, the finance ministry and the social-security institute also from the direct-debit limit.

The central bank's own annual accounts put firmer numbers on the rail than the monthly operator reports do. KWiK carried Kz 590.36 thousand million across 35,000,724 transfers in 2025, up 725.4% in value and 1,116.69% in number on a 2024 base of Kz 71.53 thousand million and 2,876,721 operations, with 23,974,751 accounts registered in the addressing module at year end and an average transfer of about Kz 17,000; the same report sets the whole payment system at more than 3,535 million operations worth Kz 463.72 biliões and records the effective end of the cheque, 4,989 items cleared against 38,664 in 2024. How much rests on how little showed in July: a cyberattack on Unitel from 02:20 on 28 July 2026 still had card terminals unreliable in Luanda shops and filling stations almost three days later, with queues at ATMs as people drew cash to transact. A trade publication reported the instant-payment scheme processing 4.48 million transfers worth Kz 123.85bn in August 2026, the number of operations up 53.3% in a year.

Registries

Angola launched its single social registry in July 2026 — the social affairs ministry's Cadastro Social Único, to map vulnerable households and direct social supports — seven years after Presidential Decree 136/19 established it. Field enrolment opened in a pilot at Sumbe on 24 August 2026.

The largest register is the electoral one, being rebuilt ahead of 2027. The territorial administration ministry put more than two million adults updated by September 2026, against more than 16.7 million targeted by 31 March 2027, with no provincial breakdown. The update targets 16,707,455 citizens and runs from 15 June 2026 to 31 March 2027 through the Balcão Único counter network, of which 254 of a planned 634 were live across all 21 provinces at the opening. It is contested: the main opposition party says state means are being used to register the governing party's members early, and a civic movement says parties and civil society are kept out of supervising the proof-of-

life step (September 2026). The President ordered a $275 million supplementary credit in the 2026 budget for the Ministry of Territorial Administration (February 2026). At the last outing the roll recorded 14,399,391 voters against a voting-age population of 15,939,218 (August 2022).

The tie to the identity card varies. Presidential Decree 245/21 makes a citizen's taxpayer number identical to their identity card number, while foreign residents and legal entities take sequential numbers from the tax authority. The undocumented must obtain an identity card before they can join the electoral base, which makes the card the gate to the vote. The tie is being made total by statute: under the 2025 official electoral registration law, in-person registration is replaced by automatic enrolment drawn from the civil identity database, and the voter card is used for the last time in 2027, after which the identity card is the sole registration credential. Angola operates no independent biometric electoral registration, and the roll has never been through a comprehensive independent technical audit.

On land, the digital cadastre runs in all 18 provincial offices of the cadastral institute, with 450,000 urban parcel boundaries mapped and a registration system built for the mass registration of 100,000 properties (2024); the SIRP property registration system is installed in all 22 registry offices, coverage concentrated in urban areas. The Executive set a target of legalising 40,000 properties by end-2026 through a platform linking the land institute, the tax authority and the property registry (April 2026). On business, the Guiché Único da Empresa issues a taxpayer number as part of incorporation, alongside commercial registration and social security enrolment, and logged more than 14,000 company constitutions in 2026. The nominal worker register RENT is live and rolling out province by province (2025), while a national farmer and producer registry was put out to tender under a World Bank-financed agriculture project in 2022.

A separate population base sits outside all this: Lei 11/20 puts the identity of suspects and victims, the offender's biometric data, social and medico-pathological history and criminal record into a database managed by the criminal police.

Sectoral management information systems

Electronic invoicing became mandatory in Angola on 1 January 2026 for large taxpayers and suppliers to the state, with invoices issued from software certified by the tax authority and transmitted in real time, on SAF-T as the data standard; 51,245 large taxpayers and state suppliers had joined by 23 August 2026, having issued 36,341,801 electronic invoices at a daily run-rate of about 400,000 through 255 certified software packages, on the collector's own figures; the obligation reaches general and simplified-regime VAT taxpayers only from 2027. The tax administration behind it is the state's most complete: AGT runs SIGT, a centralised real-time online tax system, and it is integrating with SIGFE so that electronic invoices are validated automatically before the state pays a supplier (2026).

Public financial management thins out away from the centre. SIGFE has reached 164 municipal administrations, but about 40% of municipalities lack consistent internet access and must go to the provincial capital to transact (2023). Presidential Decree 194/25 of 21 October 2025 established an integrated management system for the public investment programme, designed to share data with SIGFE, SIP and SIMAPE. A government payroll system is in use while the public-service HR management system it would draw on is still being implemented.

The line ministries' systems reach the province but not the point of service. The health ministry has been moving its information system onto DHIS2 since 2015, but at aggregation level: data are collected on paper at health facilities and then aggregated and entered at municipal or provincial level. An electronic medical record for tuberculosis care has been piloted in three Luanda health facilities, the technology otherwise largely untapped in TB services, and the health information system is held back by limited resources, inadequate infrastructure and insufficient IT training.

Education runs the same way: SIGE, the education management information system, is in operation but not a finished product, its gaps forcing the ministry onto spreadsheets to finish the 2021/22 statistical yearbook, and school statistics were collected by paper survey until a 2016 pilot in Huíla began registering schools in SIGE by tablet.

Customs runs on ASYCUDA, and on 5 January 2026 Angola became the first country to put its fifth generation, ASY5, into live operation, launched at the regional tax service in Lobito, and a social insurance and pension system runs on a hybrid of custom and commercial software (2025). Social protection delivery was assessed as nascent in 2024, the Cadastro Social Único then being linked to the Kwenda management information system and the welfare ministry's SIGAS registry, with digitisation low and interoperability limited; the register was launched in July 2026. A presidential order of 14 September 2026 authorised about US$98m, by direct award in two lots, for a customs supervision project of centralised monitoring and automated inspection; no supplier is named.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Angola's official electronic services portal listed seven services in August 2026, all free: a taxpayer-number lookup, a weather forecast, an electricity ombudsman contact, airport arrivals and departures, a commercial-licence lookup, an online CV and the complaints book. None of them completes an administrative transaction end to end: nothing on the list files an application, pays a fee or issues a document. The catalogue gives no take-up figure for any of them.

The portal is not a census of what the state does online, and the partly transactional migration and traffic services do not appear on it. Digitising passport, driving-licence and vehicle-document services at the migration service and the traffic directorate in mid-2025 ended the queues and the informal "mixeiros" fixer economy at their doors. The tax authority runs its own taxpayer portal and mobile app; the Guiché Único launched an upgraded business-formalisation platform in 2025; the electronic procurement system publishes both tender notices and awarded contracts; and the state payment reference system RUPE, run by EMIS, accounts for 36% of the state's current revenues and takes tax and fees at ATMs, POS terminals, online and by mobile (2025). Angola scored 0.4149 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, 156th of 193 member states and below the African average.

The programme is the Presidency's: the head of the Casa Civil set out the Agenda de Transição Digital da Administração Pública — 218 structuring projects across six objectives and seven axes (March 2026). The legal base has not kept pace. A digital government framework bill entered public consultation on 6 May 2026, put forward expressly to end the scattering of technology rules across separate instruments since 1997. There is still no dedicated legal regime for electronic signatures, digital certification or public key infrastructure; Lei de Autorização Legislativa n.º 12/26 of 2 October 2026 gives the President 90 days to legislate one. Meanwhile the procurement runs ahead of the law: Despacho Presidencial 11/26 of 13 January 2026 authorised Kz 8.6bn for Microsoft licences covering the whole public administration, bought centrally by the IMA. The citizen service network had 16 subunits in service in September 2026 and recorded 1.49m visits in the first half of the year; the public e-services system stayed online after a ransomware group claimed an attack on it, an intrusion that is unconfirmed.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Cubango approved an integrated document and archive management system for its own provincial administration, to run from January 2026, together with a citizen app for submitting proposals and following public tenders — a province buying a system rather than hosting one. That distinction carries most of the story. Identity-card printing now runs in every province, but it is a national issuance function moved onto provincial premises rather than a provincial system; the same holds for the electoral-register proof-of-life operation, which runs through the national

Balcão Único counter network across all 21 provinces (June 2026) on a budget the President reinforced for the Ministry of Territorial Administration (February 2026), and for Projecto Njila, coordinated by that ministry across eight provinces and dozens of municipalities (2023).

The system that does reach the municipal tier is the financial one: SIGFE has reached municipal administrations, and internet gaps in many of them limit its use (2023) — the local state's own accounting runs on a national system whose weak point is the connectivity everything else is also waiting on. Beyond it the sub-national footprint is thin and mostly judicial: the Ombudsman's virtual hearing rooms are being set up in 24 municipalities of 12 provinces, the first opened at Talatona in 2025. The one local operational system being built out beyond the capital is a surveillance one. Alongside the national police's five command-and-control centres under construction in Luanda's urban municipalities (2026), the interior ministry is installing Integrated Public Security Centres province by province: Cabinda was inaugurated as the fifth on 9 December 2025, with a 24-hour command and video-surveillance room answering the 111 emergency number, 184 cameras carrying facial recognition, number-plate reading and protection of designated strategic state sites, and 180 staff, and another was begun in Saurimo, Lunda-Sul, on 30 July 2026 with more than 100 cameras on the city's main arteries in a first phase, the centres' director-general saying the expansion is under way in almost every province and is meant to move policing from the traditional model to one built on technology. No data-protection basis, retention rule or supervisory authority is named for any of that estate.

The Portal do Munícipe was launched on 10 November 2021 across 164 municipalities, with fees paid by RUPE reference into a treasury sub-account. A report a week later found it web-only in almost all municipal seats, with parts of the interior lacking internet or power. Decreto Presidencial 176/24 made it the legal channel for local fee registration, billing and payment.

Rural digital data capture

The Ilumina Angola programme reached Lago Dilolo, a Moxico locality of 40,882 people, in June 2026, carrying voice and data there over national roaming, shared towers and antennas, solar power and ANGOSAT-2 backhaul; what happens at the counter in places like it is still written down by hand. Health facilities still collect their data on paper for aggregation at municipal or provincial level, against limited resources, inadequate infrastructure, uneven staffing and insufficient IT training (2025). An electronic medical record for tuberculosis care has so far been piloted in three Luanda health facilities (2025). School statistics were collected by paper survey until a 2016 pilot in Huíla began capturing every school's data by tablet for the education management system (2017).

Power and connectivity are the constraints, and government plans say so. Cubango's move from analogue to electronic provincial administration is designed around weak internet and electricity supply in municipalities such as Mavengue (December 2025). Rural households are far less likely than urban ones to live where the electricity grid reaches (2023). Fibre reaches every provincial and communal capital, which is a different claim from service in the municipality around it, and the government has stated that weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the chief risk to completing the electoral-register update (June 2026).

Where capture is arriving, it arrives with a donor project attached: Njila, launched in 2023, has been rehabilitating and equipping birth-registration posts, with posts coming into service from August 2025, mostly at maternal and child health centres. What that works against is visible in the census, where identity-card holding among rural residents runs far below the urban rate (2024).

Technology

AI

Angola's draft artificial-intelligence law creates a right to an explanation of, and to refuse, AI-based decisions, and then leaves the competent AI authority to a future regulation — no body is identified to vindicate those rights, nothing in the text assigns them to the data protection agency, and the bill repeals no existing legislation, so it lands on top of Law 22/11 and Lei n.º 11/20 with the interactions unstated.

The bill runs to 86 articles in nine chapters and was published for public consultation on the telecommunications ministry's portal in September 2025, claiming extraterritorial reach over AI activity conducted outside Angola that affects Angolan interests, and carrying privacy and personal-information duties, rights over intellectual property in AI-generated content and protections for digitally disadvantaged groups. One named class of system, "IA Crítica", carries additional registration, security-risk assessment, disclosure and emergency-response duties, with any wider risk classification left to a system the state is to establish; the promotion-and-development chapter sits ahead of the rights chapter, and the state is put on the supply side, promoting national computing infrastructure and the release of public data. No dedicated artificial-intelligence law is in force.

UNESCO's readiness assessment, presented on 30 June 2026, found 50.9 per cent of its indicators fully met, 32.7 per cent partially met and 16 per cent insufficient, and named the missing national AI strategy as a gap, alongside deficits in human capital and interministerial coordination. Deployment runs well behind the drafting: inside government, the tax authority has had an artificial-intelligence risk-analysis system in test to target non-compliant taxpayers (2026), and the only binding-looking commitment elsewhere is not binding — a presidential decree of 16 April 2026 approving a road-safety cooperation protocol with Portugal names the move off paper, automation and use of artificial-intelligence methodologies in the contraordenação process as an area of cooperation, while its clause 7 states the protocol is a declaration of mutual intent creating no legally binding obligations.

The consultation the bill was published into has stayed open for a year without producing a law. As at 27 August 2026 the ministry's portal still carries the September 2025 draft and records 18 contributions from companies, 18 from specialists and 5 from the general public. The state is buying a system ahead of the law: Despacho Presidencial 342/26 of 27 August 2026 authorised US$6 million and opened a public tender for an artificial-intelligence platform for the public administration, World Bank money run through the digital acceleration project, with no statement of what the platform is to do or for which bodies. In March 2026 the modernisation institute tendered a consultancy for a governance framework for digital government and for artificial intelligence in the public sector, financed through the digital acceleration project — an instrument distinct from the bill, with no published scope, drafter or timetable beyond its terms of reference.

ICT Industry

The largest event in Angola's technology sector in 2026 was a share sale rather than a product: a 15 per cent state stake in Unitel went under the PROPRIV privatisation programme for Kz 300.3 billion, reported as about US$329m, oversubscribed by more than 20 per cent across 17,549 subscription orders, with the shares appreciating more than 24 per cent on debut to about Kz 50,000 a share on 30 July 2026. That is the shape of the sector: the state selling a minority of the operator that dominates the mobile market into a domestic exchange, with the listing itself the main new market discipline on it. When a cyberattack took the same operator's mobile network down the day before trading opened, the company framed its disclosure as a listed-company obligation to keep the market and investors informed — the reporting duty that bit was securities law, not telecoms or cyber regulation.

Government demand goes mostly to foreign vendors. CEIEC and Huawei are the contractors for Phase 2 of Angola's Public Security Project surveillance network (2021), and there is no government programme for engaging GovTech startups or the private technology sector in building public digital services (2025) — so the domestic sector has no route into the state's own build. The conditions it trades under are among the country's worst: Business and Labour Environment is Angola's second-worst governance sub-category at 31.1 out of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states, though business and competition regulation within it rose 14.3 points to 51.1.

The one segment opening to local firms is satellite. ANGOSAT-2 capacity was released to commercial providers in December 2025 after years reserved for government, and a startup based in Moxico province was licensed by the regulator to sell internet access over it in July 2026.

Innovation ecosystem

Angola's domestic money for young companies is only now being deployed: the Kimbo Fund, a private equity vehicle run by BFA Asset Management and anchored with USD 5 million by the sovereign wealth fund FSDEA in 2024, made its second deal in March 2026, about USD 1.2 million in the mobility startup Anda — a size that says how thin the domestic financing layer still is.

Capital of any scale comes from outside it. Anda, an Angolan mobility and fintech startup, has raised from Breega, Speedinvest and 4DX Ventures and from the French development finance institution Proparco (2026), and a 2019 survey of the continent's innovation hubs names Disruption Lab, Acelera Angola and Bantu Makers as where such firms are incubated. On the output side, Angola ranked 138th on WIPO's Global Innovation Index in 2025, in the bottom quartile.

Absorption by the state is the weaker half. The finance ministry has a public-finance innovation laboratory, i.Lab, launched in March 2026, but across government public sector innovation is assessed as a strategy or programme only rather than an established institutional arrangement (2025) — a stated intention to innovate, without the standing machinery that would carry it between ministries or outlast the programme that announced it.

Capacity

Literacy

Education is Angola's worst-scoring sub-category in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, at 29.4 out of 100 in 2023 and 50th of 54 African states, after a rise of only 2.4 points over the decade to 2023. The measures beneath it move in different directions: Education Enrolment fell 8.4 points over the same decade to 37.7, ranking 32nd, one of the ten most deteriorated measures in the country's whole profile, while Education Completion sits at 26.4 (36th) and Education Quality at 30.7 (38th). What schooling there is remains unevenly distributed across the population.

The floor is much higher in the capital than those national scores imply. Literacy among Luanda residents aged 15 and over is 94.5% (February 2026), which places the obstacle to using a public digital service in the capital somewhere other than reading. The schools generating the national numbers were long counted on paper: school statistics were collected by paper survey until a 2016 pilot in Huíla began registering schools in the education management information system by tablet (2017). Connectivity has started to reach pupils ahead of that digitisation — nearly 4,000 students in Ramiros were connected over ANGOSAT-2 and TV White Space in July 2026. For adults, the main standing effort is Cidadão Digital, a digital financial literacy programme run by EMIS with the central bank. More than 2,000 computers had been installed across 88 schools by August 2026, on the minister's own count.

Training and skills

The 2024 Ibrahim Index cannot score Angola on its teaching workforce at all: Human Resources in Education is one of only two of the index's 96 indicators for which the country returns no data for 2023. Provision inside the state is at an early stage on the same evidence — the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index recorded digital-skills training for public servants in 2025 as a strategy or programme rather than an established institutional function, covering basic digital skills and data literacy through freely available material.

The domestic tertiary pipeline in computing is small and named: Universidade Agostinho Neto's engineering and natural sciences faculties, ISPTEC's MSc in computer science covering cybersecurity and software engineering, and UniLuanda's INSTIC are the established ICT degree programmes. Of 29,302 graduates in 2022-23, 162, or 0.55%, qualified in information and communication technology and fewer than 3,200, or 11%, in science, technology, engineering and mathematics, on a business magazine's reading of the higher education ministry's latest yearbook. A UNESCO readiness assessment reported in June 2026 put the availability of a STEM-qualified workforce among the country's weaker points.

Most of the training capacity now being added arrives attached to a supplier or a lender rather than to a public institution. Angola runs an ICT skills training partnership with Huawei working to a 2027 target; skills development is one of the three arms of the World Bank's Angola Digital Acceleration Project, and people trained is one of its 2030 results targets. Cybersecurity training with the Cisco Networking Academy was announced as part of the Cybastion–Angola Telecom package in June 2025, and cybersecurity cooperation and the exchange of professional expertise sit inside the Angola–Namibia ICT memorandum signed at ANGOTIC 2026. The regulator itself has been on the receiving end: Portugal's ANACOM met INACOM and the EU Delegation in Luanda in March 2026 to present an institutional-strengthening training initiative in ICT policy and regulation.

Research institutions

The largest funded commitment to the universities' research base is the World Bank's tertiary education, science and technology project, appraised in November 2023, which carries US$15m to establish a national research and education network and upgrade university networks; no operator or connection count is published. In space science, GGPEN and Nigeria's National Space Research and Development Agency signed a space-science cooperation agreement at ANGOTIC 2026 in Luanda in June 2026. The domestic base that would carry such work is narrow, resting on the same few institutions that teach computing — Universidade Agostinho Neto, ISPTEC and UniLuanda's INSTIC. Corporate research presence remains prospective: Huawei stated on 2 October 2025, after an audience with President João Lourenço, that it intends to establish a research and development centre in Angola by 2027 aimed at digital inclusion, education, health and connectivity.

Inclusion

Access to services

Angola delivers services no more equally after a decade of digitisation: its equal-access-to-public-services score was 30.6 out of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 African states and slightly lower than in 2014. The gate in front of most of those services is the identity card, whose coverage is incomplete: it is a prerequisite for education, municipal administrative services, registering property and vehicles, applying for a job and opening a bank account.

Where a service is designed around the people it must reach, it works. Kwenda had reached more than 1.3 million households, about 6.5 million people, by July 2026, and beneficiaries with disabilities receive a Multicaixa-linked payment card alongside assistive items such as wheelchairs, with community workers delivering benefits to the homes of those who cannot travel to distribution points (2025). Free connectivity now reaches the general public as

well as named institutions: the President put free internet access points in 18 provinces at about eight million citizens reached (October 2026), Conecta Angola had delivered 32 public access points and connected six universities by June 2026, more than 5,600 University of Namibe students were set to get free internet over ANGOSAT-2 from June 2026, and satellite capacity with TV White Space connected 3,972 students in Ramiros in July 2026.

Elsewhere the digital channel moves the obstacle rather than removing it. Digitising passport, driving-licence and vehicle-document services in mid-2025 cleared the crowds and the informal "mixeiros" fixer economy from the doors of the migration service and the traffic directorate, but users could not follow the steps for a first driving licence on the traffic portal, and documents still arrived slowly after the digital application (November 2025).

Access that runs over one network is only as reliable as that network. The Unitel outage from 28 July 2026 cut off ride-hailing, balance checks and payments for days, pushing subscribers onto Africell and Movicel and slowing those networks too, and small-business owners were still counting the cost on 10 August 2026, bookings by phone and payments by card terminal having both been severed, while one customer said he learned of the outage through other channels rather than from the operator. The government's financial-inclusion rate stood at 51.7% in the first quarter of 2026, against a 2027 target of 65%.

Digital divides

Weak internet and mobile coverage in hard-to-reach areas is the government's stated chief risk to completing the electoral-register update (June 2026) — the divide has stopped being a development statistic and become a constraint on the franchise.

The instrument meant to close it dates from November 2010 and obliges nobody to publish what it does. The Fundo de Apoio ao Desenvolvimento das Comunicações rests on a presidential decree rather than a statute, and is funded from a standing annual levy on the private sector: the 2010 decree sets it at 1% of the gross revenue of public telecommunications operators and service providers, alongside a share of the regulator INACOM's receipts, with its priority areas left to ministerial despacho. Its non-repayable grants are reserved for non-commercial expansion of universal service into disadvantaged areas, and its only reporting duty is an annual plan and a report and accounts sent to the supervising ministry.

The divide it exists to address is measured repeatedly, and always along the same line. Every measure that splits by settlement splits the same way: identity-card holding falls off sharply between urban and rural residents, under-five birth registration is almost twice as high in towns, 48.7% against 24.8% (2023–24), registered property parcels are a small fraction of those mapped and cluster in urban areas, and rural residents live overwhelmingly outside the reach of the electricity grid everything else depends on. Where the exclusion is not geographic it is administrative: near-universal adult literacy in Luanda means the province's own documentation gap cannot be explained by schooling.

Schooling is nonetheless where Angola ranks worst on the divides that feed everything else. Its equality-in-education score was 30.7 out of 100 in 2023, 47th of 54 African states, and that is after a rise of more than nine points across the decade to 2023. Language runs alongside it: national languages other than Portuguese are widely spoken, which drives the multilingual requirement on broadcast and public-information services.

Data

National statistics

Angola's weakest point in official statistics is the collection of the data itself: across the five pillars of the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators the country sits in the 70-89% band for data use and data products, the 50-69% band for data services and infrastructure, and only the 20-49% band for data sources (2023).

That is not for want of censuses. A population census, an agricultural census and a business census were all conducted within the preceding ten years (2023), and the definitive results of the 2024 population census were published in November 2025, confirming Luanda as the province concentrating the largest share of the population. The survey programme is more uneven: three or more business surveys and three or more labour surveys over the decade, but only two household surveys and two health surveys, and no agricultural survey at all — the one survey type recorded as missing entirely (2023).

Administrative systems are not yet a substitute for that collection. The health ministry's DHIS2 platform runs at the aggregation level, with data collected on paper at health facilities and entered at municipal or provincial level (2025); most civil registration and identification records remain in unindexed paper files (2024), a position a 2021 assessment traced to the absence of civil registration infrastructure in rural areas. The education system's own platform, SIGE, is in operation but not a finished product, its gaps forcing the ministry onto spreadsheets to finish the 2021/22 statistical yearbook.

The share of Angolan businesses on the tax register is not established: INE's business census counted around 83,700 enterprises, roughly two thirds of them formal (2019–20). Other basic measures have simply stopped: international internet bandwidth per user was last measured in 2015, and the Ibrahim Index leaves Angola unscored for human resources in education for want of reported data (2023). A UNESCO readiness assessment scored the country's data governance at 47 out of 100 (June 2026), and a World Bank programme running to 2027 is funding modernisation of the statistical system and INE's own capacity; its first component covers an inventory and evaluation of the administrative data already held across the public administration, and was the subject of a meeting on 16 September 2025 at which Statistics Portugal shared its national data infrastructure and the simplified business return that let it retire its own annual business survey — the route by which the collection gap above would be closed without new field operations.

The institute doing that work was restated in law in March 2026. Presidential Decree 43/26 revokes the 2017 organic statute and re-establishes INE as the national statistical authority with technical, administrative, financial and patrimonial autonomy under the superintendence of the ministerial department responsible for planning, writing technical independence, neutrality, impartiality, confidentiality and transparency into the text and reorganising it into five executive directorates plus local services. Its census products carry their own quality apparatus and their own unexplained gap: a coverage survey of the 2024 census was published in November 2025, and the Luanda provincial report closing the series in February 2026 puts the province at 8,665,510 people and Cacuaco at 875,071, where INE's own national synthesis puts the province at 8,816,297 and Cacuaco at 1,025,859, the other fifteen municipalities matching to the person and no reason for the difference given. The institute put a revision of the statistics law and a draft statistics strategy for 2026 to 2032 to public consultation from 29 September to 2 October 2026.

Open data

Angola has no open data portal, and the sub-indicators covering what such a portal would publish are recorded as not applicable in consequence in the World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment. One is now committed rather than merely absent: the digital acceleration project's safeguards plan records Component 2 undertaking to create a

shared data-governance framework, shared infrastructure, an open-data portal and electronic services — a commitment recited in a safeguards instrument rather than in a data policy of its own, with nothing published as operating.

The absence is of a piece with the rest. The documentation behind most of the country's assessed government systems, strategies and oversight functions — the interoperability framework, the tax and procurement systems, the national service portal, the digital government mandate, the digital transformation strategy and the data protection authority's reporting — is held internally and not published (2025). The Ibrahim Index puts the same split in numbers: 34.8 out of 100 for the accessibility of public records, 20th of 54 African states, against 16.5 for the disclosure of those records, 44th of 54 and up only 2.7 points over the decade to 2023.

Among published statistics, coverage and openness are strongest on the external accounts — balance of payments and international trade each score 6 out of 10 on Open Data Watch's Open Data Inventory (2024) — and weakest on the environment and prices, with pollution at 2.5 and agriculture, energy and price statistics each at 3. Social statistics fall between 3 and 4.5, population, poverty, health and education outcomes among them.

There is a right to information law that the GovTech assessment rates as in force and effective rather than adopted and dormant; it is Lei n.º 11/02 of 16 August 2002, the Lei de Acesso aos Documentos Administrativos, and no implementing regulation, oversight body or request statistics under it is published. What is published is not always sound: Novo Jornal found surplus zeros in the telecoms ministry's 2025 procurement plan and reported on 21 February 2025 that the document had still not been corrected. Publication is firmer in procurement generally, where the electronic system publishes both tender notices and awarded contracts (2025), and outside government altogether: Multicaixa runs a public statistics portal carrying monthly terminal counts, transaction volumes and values by channel (2026). Where openness meets personal data the answer has gone the other way — in June 2026 the National Assembly rejected a bill that would have opened voters' electoral personal data to wider access by citizens and parties, on privacy grounds.

Use of satellite data

Angola's Earth-observation capability is being built rather than used: the ANGEO-1 contract, worth about €225m, was formally launched at Toulouse on 16 March 2026 by the telecommunications minister at Airbus, framed by the government as securing sovereign access to critical Earth-observation data. The satellite is being built by Airbus Defence and Space on its S250 optical platform; the programme passed its System Key Point milestone in May 2026, with the first Earth-observation ground infrastructure due for delivery from June.

The imagery is intended for soil and agriculture, urban mapping, environmental monitoring, mining, oil and gas, and border control (March 2026). GGPEN, which runs the ANGEO-1 programme with Airbus, is already marketing downstream services — Earth-observation products using high-resolution imagery, artificial intelligence and geospatial data for infrastructure monitoring, asset management and land-use mapping (June 2026). What the state is spending is now published at a plausible order of magnitude: the ministry's corrected 2025 procurement plan puts satellite construction and launch at Kz 712.7 milhões and the Earth-observation system at Kz 77.7 milhões, the latter reclassified as a new contract (March 2025).

The working use of geospatial data meanwhile sits on the ground, in the digital cadastre the national geographic and cadastral institute has deployed across its provincial offices (2024). Angola's other satellite activity is connectivity, not observation: ANGOSAT-2 is operated from the Funda Mission Control Centre and its capacity opened to commercial internet providers in December 2025; Eutelsat holds a 15-year licence for OneWeb low-earth-orbit service, the only licensed LEO operator, with a Luanda ground station (June 2025), and took a multi-year capacity

agreement with the Angolan provider Mercury Telecom in June 2026. The cooperation signed around ANGOTIC 2026 — with Nigeria's space agency, with Mozambique, whose Boane earth station already receives the ANGOSAT-2 signal, and with Telecom Namibia — sits on that same side.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Account data on US taxpayers held at Angolan financial institutions goes to the US Internal Revenue Service under a bilateral tax agreement, for which the President approved about €552,000 in June 2026 in software licensing under Angola's FATCA agreement with the United States.

The largest American commercial position is Cybastion's, and it is still a framework: the firm's partnership with Angola Telecom rests on a memorandum of understanding signed at Mobile World Congress in Barcelona in March 2025, and the package announced that June at the US–Africa Business Summit in Luanda — a national cybersecurity agency, Cisco Networking Academy training and a Luanda–Lobito undersea cable — remains an announcement against it, which would put one American commercial actor inside both the cyber-institution build and the connectivity build. American public lending reached the networks first: the US Export-Import Bank announced a US$99.6 million loan to Africell, the private mobile operator, for technology investment in Angola in September 2026.

Where American suppliers are already embedded is the public administration's software: a presidential despacho of January 2026 authorised the central procurement of Microsoft licences for the whole of public administration through the IMA, replacing per-institution buying with a single commitment to one foreign vendor's licensing stack. On the network side, Angola Cables extended its Atlantic wholesale backbone in May 2026 through a partnership with Uniti Wholesale that gives it reach across a 386,000 km US fibre network, adding to its SACS, MONET and WACS routes.

Starlink was still unlicensed in Angola in June 2026, the Secretary of State for Telecommunications saying only that licensing was under way. Angola took its digital transition agenda, then numbering 214 structuring projects, to the World Bank's Digital Summit in Washington in March 2025.

China activities

The platform that carries civil identity in Angola was built by a Chinese state consultancy, and the state cannot yet run it alone: the World Bank's 2024 diagnostic found technical coordination of the PGIBI identity platform provided by the Chinese state firm CEIEC, amid limited human and logistical resources, and recommended standard operating procedures backed by staff training.

A presidential despacho of January 2017 selected the state-owned CEIEC to implement the Plataforma de Gestão Integrada da Identificação Civil e Criminal, contracted through the Ministry of Justice and Human Rights and framed against a Chinese commercial credit line, and the civil registration system has run on Chinese-devised technology since 2020. The national BI production centre at Kilamba, opened in November 2019, is where that platform meets the public.

The same contractors run the security build. CEIEC and Huawei implement Phase 2 of the Public Security Project, the CCTV network in Luanda and the provincial centres together with the integrated centres that monitor what it collects, for which China Eximbank approved a commercial loan in December 2021. China Eximbank is also the

concessional lender behind the National Broadband Network, under a framework agreement of January 2023 and a loan agreement that October, with Sinohydro as implementing contractor for terrestrial fibre, a submarine line to Cabinda and modernisation of the core network.

Huawei's position has since widened past equipment. It signed an agreement with the health ministry in 2026 for the progressive digitisation of hospitals covering telemedicine and artificial intelligence, it runs an ICT skills training partnership with the government, and after an audience with President Lourenço on 2 October 2025 its director-general for Portuguese-speaking countries said the firm intends to establish a research and development centre in Angola.

The payments link is being built alongside: BAI, the largest private bank, signed a memorandum with Bank of China in September 2026 for a renminbi clearing account and indirect access to China's cross-border interbank payment system, for Angola–China trade.

EU activities

ANGEO-1, Angola's first national Earth-observation satellite, passed its System Key Point milestone with Airbus in May 2026. The contract had been formally launched at Airbus's Toulouse facilities on 16 March 2026 by the telecommunications minister, with Airbus building the satellite on its S250 optical platform, and the government presents it as securing sovereign access to critical Earth-observation data. The money is European as well as the manufacturing: a €225,257,201 financing package arranged through Société Générale, signed at the Angola–France Economic Forum in January 2025.

Travel documents sit with a European supplier too. Angola signed a EUR 130 million (about USD 139 million) passport-and-identity contract with the Hungary-based ANY Security Printing Company in 2023, financed by Hungary's EXIM Bank and covering enrolment stations, a local personalisation facility and ten years of passport delivery.

EU money itself is in registration rather than infrastructure. Nascer com Registo, EU-funded and UNICEF-supported and run by the justice, health and social action ministries, places registry posts inside maternity wards so that newborns leave registered and issued a first Bilhete de Identidade; it has registered newborns at the Zaire provincial hospital since October 2025 and was formally launched at Mbanza Kongo in March 2026.

Three smaller European positions complete the picture: Eutelsat holds a 15-year licence to operate OneWeb low-earth-orbit connectivity with a ground station in Luanda, the only licensed LEO operator in the country (June 2025); Portugal's regulator ANACOM presented an institutional-strengthening training initiative in ICT policy and regulation to INACOM and the EU Delegation in Luanda in March 2026; and the French development finance institution Proparco is among the investors in the Angolan mobility and fintech startup Anda, alongside Breega, Speedinvest and 4DX Ventures.

Gulf/UAE activities

Angola's government data centre and national cloud was inaugurated by President Lourenço in April 2026, led by INFOSI and built with the Abu Dhabi companies Presight and G42, and the government presents it as an assertion of digital sovereignty.

What it is built to came from Abu Dhabi as well. The national cloud originates in a memorandum of understanding signed in December 2021 between the governments of Angola and the United Arab Emirates, operationalised between the Emirati firm Presight and MINTTICS, and its agreed heads were a three-year digitalisation master plan for Angola, public-private partnerships, build-operate-transfer and other financing channels, digital skills and workforce development for Angolan youth, and further projects of mutual interest. The master plan the sovereign

cloud answers to was therefore a deliverable of the Gulf partner that went on to build it, and the financing head the two governments agreed was build-operate-transfer. A memorandum binds neither side to spend, and the Presight relationship rests on one. The space programme office signed a letter of intent with the UAE Space Agency in September 2026, naming satellite-data exchange and Earth-observation applications among areas of possible cooperation.

India activities

India's USD 200 million credit line to Angola, announced at the New Delhi state visit of 3 May 2025, is for modernisation of the armed forces, not for digital systems; alongside it, and with no figure attached, Prime Minister Modi said India would share its capabilities in digital public infrastructure, space technology and capacity building. That offer was made with no vendor, figure or timetable attached.

Digital sovereignty

Angola has begun procuring its first rules on where state data may be hosted and what exit terms suppliers must accept: terms of reference of March 2026 under the World Bank-financed digital acceleration project commission a national policy and regulation on managing and hosting public data, with hosting rules by data category, from on-premises to conditions for public cloud, minimum contract clauses for suppliers on audit, subcontracting, reversibility and exit, and rules on localisation and transfers. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026.

The hosting itself is already on national soil. The US$89 million government cloud at Camama is run by the state IT agency INFOSI, and its twelve modules held Tier III certification in the name of Presight, of the Abu Dhabi G42 group, while the building awaited its own audit (May 2026); a rebuilt backup centre on INFOSI's premises, 48 racks and about 8.5 petabytes, replicates it in real time (August 2026), and ANGOSAT-2 gives it a further continuity path. The terms on which the December 2021 memorandum with the United Arab Emirates and the agreements with Presight and G42 govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The state does not hold the source code of its civil-registration software, which stays locked to its vendor (2024). Whether the state holds the source code and operating skills for the PGIBI identity platform, or can exit its operating contract, was not on record as at September 2026.

The AI layer is being bought the same way: a US$6 million public-sector AI platform authorised under Despacho Presidencial 342/26 and financed through the World Bank project is framed as giving the state sovereign capacity to adopt, develop and operate AI (September 2026). The government's own definition is control rather than closure: the telecommunications minister defined digital sovereignty in August 2026 as the state's capacity to govern its digital space and choose technologies in the national interest, not technological isolation.

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